



STATUS REPORT

Eritrea: status report

Edition of 2026-08-19 · 12 systems and instruments tracked, 4 of them not held

Compiled 2026-08-19 from the Data Landscapers source base, from [outputs/reports/ERI/ledger.csv](#) (12 systems and instruments, 4 of them **Not held**). Each section opens with its ledger; specific events are covered in the monthly updates. Figures are dated because most are time-varying.

Status values. *Implemented* — in operation or in force. *Piloting* — running with a limited user group or in a controlled environment. *In development* — build or drafting under way, not yet operating. *Planned* — announced or provided for, no build or draft on record. *Enacted* — an instrument passed into law; pair with a qualifying clause for its in-force date. *Under review* — a law or policy currently being reconsidered. *Discontinued* — closed or superseded. *Not held* — the base carries no reliable statement of status; these are the gaps to fill and are listed again at the end.

Summary of position

Eritrea's digitally-tracked state consists of a small number of discrete projects rather than a connected system: a customs platform delivered with UNDP support in January 2026 ([ASYCUDA World](#)), a completed national household survey using digital data collection ([EPHS 2025](#)), and a domestically built offline AI application ([Eri-Chat](#)). No foundational digital-ID system, mobile-money service or data-protection law is held on record. Connectivity is among the lowest recorded on the continent — [23.7% of the population held a mobile connection in late 2025](#) — and the state telecom monopoly EriTel reports no submarine cable landing and, as of July 2026, [no announced Starlink launch date](#). A July 2026 legal notice ordering all cash deposited into banks by 31 July or "face legal action" is the period's most consequential governance development, issued against a cash-based, under-banked economy. The evidence base itself is unusually constrained: the outlets producing dated material are limited to Eritrea's Ministry of Information (Shabait) and the diaspora/opposition outlet Awate.com, neither neutral, with harder figures coming from UNDP/UNECA and reference indices.

Infrastructure

Connectivity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
EriTel national network expansion programme	IMPLEMENTED, ONGOING EXPANSION ↗	Minister reports 184 towers installed, ~90% geographic mobile coverage, service 'reaching 4G level' (government claim)
Starlink satellite internet service	NOT HELD	Starlink's own coverage-availability map lists Eritrea 'No planned launch date'

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Submarine fibre-optic cable landing	NOT HELD	Cable industry calls Eritrea a 'black hole' that does not answer landing requests; still cable-less as of Apr 2026

Eritrea's international connectivity runs entirely on satellite. The country holds no submarine fibre-optic cable landing, and cable firms describe the government as unresponsive even to a Red Sea route sought after Houthi attacks made Yemeni waters unusable — a position unchanged as of April 2026 and one that leaves Eritrea, on the industry's own undated count, as the sole non-landing state among Africa's 38 coastal countries. [Starlink](#), available in half of Africa's sovereign states by July 2026, carries no announced launch date for Eritrea, one of only seven African states — all in the north or the Horn — in that position; no licence application or refusal has been found. Domestically, the state telecom monopoly EriTel [reports 184 towers installed and roughly 90% geographic mobile coverage as of May 2026](#), alongside international bandwidth risen to about 1,536 Mbps over the preceding decade — figures from the responsible minister that cannot be independently verified.

Digital public infrastructure

Data Exchange

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
ASYCUDA World customs platform	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Inaugurated 2026-01-08, replacing 2007-era customs software

Digital Identity and CRVS

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
National foundational digital ID	NOT HELD, PROFILED 2025-07-26	Global Digital Identity Index profile finds no operational foundational ID; sets out the barriers a future system would face

Digital Payments and Fintech

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Mobile money / digital payments service	NOT HELD	—

National statistics

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Fourth Round Eritrea Population and Health Survey (EPHS 2025)	IMPLEMENTED, COMPLETED; REPORT PENDING 2026 ↗	NSO reports survey completion: 9,794 households, 405 enumeration areas, 98.4% household completion, CAPI digital collection

The clearest concrete step in the period is the [January 2026 launch of ASYCUDA World](#), UNCTAD's automated customs platform, replacing software in use since 2007; the deployment came with a full transfer of source code to the Eritrean government, a national-ownership condition rather than a licensed or hosted arrangement. Statistical infrastructure has also advanced: [the National Statistics Office completed the Fourth Round Population and Health Survey in 2025](#), covering 9,794 households across all six regions using tablet-based interviewing rather than paper forms, with the full report due in 2026 under a UNDP/UNECA-backed programme that has funded Eritrean

statistical-capacity building since at least 2019. No foundational digital-identity system is held on record — [an analytical profile finds the country lacks one](#) and sets out what a future system would have to overcome — and no mobile-money or digital-payments service is held either, consistent with the cash-based, under-banked economy discussed under Governance below.

Governance and regulation

Legislation and regulation

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Bank of Eritrea cash-deposit legal notice	ENACTED, DEPOSIT DEADLINE 2026-07-31 ↗	Legal notice issued (~30 Jun 2026) ordering cash held outside banks deposited by 31 Jul 2026 or face legal action

Data protection

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Data-protection law	NOT HELD	—

The one governance development on record is a [Bank of Eritrea legal notice](#), issued around 30 June 2026 and reported by the diaspora/opposition outlet Awate.com with the notice's own text embedded, ordering individuals and institutions to deposit cash held outside banks by 31 July 2026 "or face legal action." The notice defines neither an "excessive amount" nor an enforcement mechanism. No data-protection law, bill or regulator designation is held on record.

Artificial intelligence and the technology sector

AI

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Eri-Chat offline AI app	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Q&A profile of developer Naod Goitom Isaac; app launched April 2025, showcased at Asmara UN Day event, Oct 2025

Innovation ecosystem

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Shambko Apps Group Tigrinya-language applications	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Five applications released, described in a 2026-08-15 interview

The base holds one concrete AI/innovation data point: [Eri-Chat](#), an offline artificial-intelligence mobile application built by a Ministry of Information software developer and launched in April 2025, storing conversation data only on the user's device. It was showcased to ambassadors and UN officials at Asmara's UN Day event in October 2025; it remains English-only, its developer citing insufficient training data for Eritrea's other languages.

Inclusion and capacity

The base holds no inclusion and capacity rows for Eritrea. A thin evidence base is a finding, not a gap in this document.

No dedicated inclusion or capacity-building instrument is held for Eritrea. The only inclusion-relevant record is the mobile-connectivity trend carried under Infrastructure above; its movement over the past twelve months is set out in the progress report.

Finance

New investments

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
UNDP 'Economic & Social Data Development Eritrea' grant (IATI 00099544)	IN DEVELOPMENT, ACTIVE (PER IATI RECORD) ↗	UNDP commits US\$1,676,837 grant to the Government of Eritrea / National Statistics Office

The only tracked non-state finance record is a [US\\$1,676,837 UNDP grant](#) to the National Statistics Office, committed in 2019 with an end year of 2026, funding the statistical-capacity building that produced EPHS 2025. The wiki's domestic-state budget layer is not currently populated for Eritrea.

Gaps to fill

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
National foundational digital ID	A named programme, pilot or vendor engagement for a foundational digital-ID system distinct from the passport/civil-registration base already on file.	not yet probed
Submarine fibre-optic cable landing	A licensing decision, application, or a dated update to the Submarine Networks registry's coastal-state count.	not yet probed
Starlink satellite internet service	A licence application, refusal, or an updated Starlink coverage-map entry for Eritrea.	not yet probed
Mobile money / digital payments service	A named mobile-money operator, licence or pilot, or a central-bank statement on digital payments distinct from the cash-deposit ultimatum.	not yet probed
Data-protection law	A published data-protection bill, statute or regulator designation.	not yet probed

The table above sets out what would settle each of the absences noted through this document: a named digital-ID programme, a cable-landing decision, a Starlink licensing outcome, a named mobile-money service, and a published data-protection instrument.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

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Figures are dated because most are time-varying: a figure carries the date it was true, not the date you are reading it. Where the base holds no reliable statement, the document says **Not held** rather than leaving a silence — those are counted, and listed at the end.

This is a dated edition and is not revised after publication. If a figure here has moved, the current edition will say so.